

MarEng Grammar

THE USE OF THE DEFINITE ARTICLE WITH GEOGRAPHICAL NAMES

No article

Continents:	Asia, Europe, America, Africa
Countries:	England, France, Finland, Kuwait BUT The United Kingdom
Islands:	Cuba, Hawaii, Cyprus, Crete, Rhodes, Åland, Utö
Cities:	London, New York, Helsinki, Brussels BUT The Hague
Lakes:	Lake Michigan, Lake Ontario, Lake Tanganyika, Lake Saimaa, Lake Ladoga, BUT The Kategat.

The definite article "the" is used with

Oceans/Sea:	The Pacific Ocean, The Atlantic, The Baltic Sea, The Mediterranean
Gulfs:	The Gulf of Finland, The Gulf of Bothnia, The Persian Gulf
Channels/straits:	The English Channel, The Straits of Gibraltar
Rivers/Canals:	The Thames, The Nile, The Rhine, The Suez Canal, The Saimaa Canal
Currents:	The North Atlantic Drift, The Gulf Stream
Plural names:	The Canary Islands, The Hebrides, The Rocky Mountains, The Alps, The Netherlands